



SESSION 3 — COACH

Trust & Safety

The foundation of a strong team

COACH OBJECTIVE

Coaches create conditions where players feel safe to make mistakes, be honest, and be vulnerable. Psychological safety is the strongest predictor of team performance.

COACH NOTE

Model vulnerability yourself: share a moment when you as a coach made a mistake and what you learned from it. If the coach can do this, so can the players. Watch out for players who are silent — check in with them individually after the session.

ACTIVITIES**1 Trust meter**

⌚ 5 min

Players anonymously write a number 1–10 on a piece of paper: how safe do I feel in this team to make mistakes? Collect, calculate average, discuss.

2 Mistakes as learning moments

⌚ 15 min

Everyone shares in the group one sports moment when they made a mistake and what they learned. Coach goes first. Emphasis: no judgment, no laughter — only listening.

3 Adding trust agreements

⌚ 10 min

Add 2 agreements to the team contract specifically about safety: e.g. "We don't respond negatively to mistakes during training" and "We discuss problems internally, not via social media".

NOTES



DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- When did you feel UNSAFE in a team? What was the effect?
- What can you do to make it safer for others?
- How does this team respond when someone makes a big mistake in a game?

CLOSING

Close with a commitment round: each player says one thing they will do to make the team safer. Write this on the board and photograph it.

NOTES

"Vulnerability is not weakness. It's the courage to show up and be seen."

— Brené Brown